Appendix B. Step-by-step AI-assisted policy authoring

This appendix provides a hands-on, step-by-step walkthrough for using AI-assisted development tools to help author and review authorization policies. It is intended to be used alongside a code editor, following the examples in the companion repository as you read.

This appendix focuses on how to apply AI assistance in practice. It does not explain why AI can be useful for policy authoring or what role authorization plays in AI-enabled systems. Those topics are covered in chapter 17. It also does not introduce Cedar syntax or policy fundamentals, which are covered earlier in the book.

Readers should approach this appendix with the companion repository open in an AI-enabled editor such as Cursor. The steps are designed to be followed in order, with short pauses to interact with the tools and review results.

> ***NOTE***
>
> The examples in this appendix make use of Cursor and the GitHub repository `acme-cedar-ai-authoring` (https://github.com/windley/acme-cedar-ai-authoring).

B.1 Why AI assistance is useful in policy authoring

Authorization policies encode intent in a form that must be precise, unambiguous, and deterministic. Translating business intent into executable